

THE *Wendy's* COMPANY
**2025 ANNUAL
REPORT**





THE WENDY'S COMPANY

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

ARTHUR B. WINKLEBLACK ^{1, 2, 5, 6}

Chairman, The Wendy's Company
Former Executive Vice President and
Chief Financial Officer, H. J. Heinz Company

PETER W. MAY ^{2, 3, 4, 5, 8}

Senior Vice Chairman, The Wendy's Company
President and Founding Partner,
Triam Fund Management, L.P.

WENDY C. ARLIN ^{1, 2, 3, 7}

Former Executive Vice President and
Chief Financial Officer, Bath & Body Works, Inc.

MICHELLE CARUSO-CABRERA ^{1, 4}

Chief Executive Officer, MCC Global
Enterprises, LLC and CNBC Contributor

KRISTIN A. DOLAN ^{6, 8}

Chief Executive Officer, AMC Networks Inc.

RICHARD H. GOMEZ ^{3, 4, 7, 8}

Former Executive Vice President and
Chief Commercial Officer, Target Corporation

MICHELLE "MICH" J. MATHEWS-SPRADLIN ^{3, 6, 7, 8}

Former Chief Marketing Officer and
Senior Vice President, Microsoft Corporation

BRADLEY G. PELTZ ^{4, 8}

Managing Director, Yellow Cab Holdings, LLC

PETER H. ROTHSCHILD ^{1, 3, 5, 6, 7}

Partner, East Wind Advisors, LLC

1. Member of Audit Committee
2. Member of Capital and Investment Committee
3. Member of Compensation and Human Capital Committee
4. Member of Corporate Social Responsibility Committee
5. Member of Executive Committee
6. Member of Nominating and Corporate Governance Committee
7. Member of Performance Compensation Subcommittee
8. Member of Technology Committee

LEADERSHIP TEAM

KEN COOK

Interim Chief Executive Officer
& Chief Financial Officer

PETE SUERKEN

President, U.S.

E.J. WUNSCH

President, International

LINDSAY J. RADKOSKI

Chief Marketing Officer, U.S.

JOHN MIN

Chief Legal Officer and Secretary

MATTHEW P. SPESSARD

Chief Information Officer

LILIANA M. ESPOSITO

Chief Corporate Affairs & Sustainability Officer

M. COLEY O'BRIEN

Chief People Officer

SUZIE THUERK

Chief Accounting Officer

CORPORATE INFORMATION

CORPORATE OFFICE RESTAURANT SUPPORT CENTER

The Wendy's Company
One Dave Thomas Boulevard
Dublin, OH 43017

614.764.3100

www.wendys.com

SEC CERTIFICATIONS

The certifications of the Company's Chief Executive Officer and Chief Financial Officer required to be filed with the Securities and Exchange Commission pursuant to Sections 302 and 906 of the Sarbanes-Oxley Act of 2002 are included as exhibits to the Company's Annual Report on Form 10-K for the fiscal year ended December 28, 2025, a copy of which (including the certifications) is included herein.

STOCKHOLDER INFORMATION TRANSFER AGENT & REGISTRAR

If you are a stockholder of record and require assistance with your account, such as a change of address or change in registration, please contact:

EQ Shareowner Services
1110 Centre Pointe Curve, Suite 101
Mendota Heights, MN 55120

Toll free: 888.888.0312 or 651.450.4064

E-mail: Visit shareowneronline.com and navigate to Contact Us

www.shareowneronline.com

INDEPENDENT REGISTERED PUBLIC ACCOUNTING FIRM

Deloitte & Touche LLP
330 Rush Alley Suite 800
Columbus, OH 43215

INVESTOR INQUIRIES

Stockholders, securities analysts, investment managers, and others seeking information about the Company may either go to the Company's Investor Relations website, www.irwendys.com, or contact the Company directly as follows:

Aaron Broholm
Head of Investor Relations
614.764.3345
aaron.broholm@wendys.com

NEWS MEDIA INQUIRIES

Heidi S. Schauer
Vice President, Communications,
Public Affairs, and Customer Care
614.764.3368
heidi.schauer@wendys.com

COMMON STOCK LISTING

WEN | Nasdaq Listed



THE WENDY'S® COMPANY

DEAR FELLOW STOCKHOLDERS,

Since stepping into the role of Interim Chief Executive Officer last year, I've had the privilege of working closely with our restaurant teams, franchisees, restaurant support center employees and partners across the Wendy's system. I've seen the strength of our brand and the dedication of the people who bring it to life every day.

While I am encouraged by the commitment and resilience across our system, we must also recognize that 2025 was a challenging year and our results fell short of the full potential of the Wendy's brand. The U.S. business faced a more competitive environment than we anticipated, as consumers came under increased pressure and our performance did not reflect the strength of our brand or the capabilities of our system.

In response, we conducted a thorough review of our business, which led to several important strategic decisions. Chief among them was the decision to get back to who we are at our best and reclaim our position as the highest quality hamburger choice in QSR.

We moved quickly to formalize this direction through Project Fresh, our strategic turnaround plan for the U.S. business. Over the past several months, we have aligned the organization as *One Wendy's* and sharpened our focus on strengthening the system through disciplined execution of this plan. Project Fresh is designed to restore momentum, elevate the customer experience and drive sustainable average unit volume (AUV) growth while continuing to build on the strong performance and expansion of our international business. As this foundational work takes hold, we expect improved performance and long-term, sustainable growth in the U.S. In our Company-operated restaurants, we have seen early progress under the operational excellence pillar in improved accuracy and higher overall customer satisfaction.



DRIVING PROGRESS UNDER PRESSURE

In 2025, we made meaningful progress in areas essential to the long-term success of the system.

Across our U.S. Company-operated restaurants, we improved our customer-focused execution, resulting in an increase in customer satisfaction scores. We are partnering with franchisees to extend these operational enhancements more broadly across the system. When we improve customer satisfaction and increase frequency, we see strengthened restaurant economics and higher AUVs, which ultimately leads to franchisee success and stockholder value.

Our digital business continued to scale, with U.S. digital sales growing more than 12% year-over-year, supported by enhancements to our mobile app that deepened customer engagement and achieved record conversion rates.

Our international business remained a strong growth engine, with systemwide sales increasing by more

than 8%. We achieved growth in existing stronghold markets like Canada, successfully entered seven new markets and opened the highest number of net new restaurants in the history of our international business. These results indicate that our strategy is working and the investments made in local resources are delivering meaningful benefits for the business, as we execute our *Globally Great, Locally Loved* strategy.

Our approach to capital allocation remained disciplined and balanced – centered on investing in the highest return opportunities to drive growth while returning capital to shareholders. We returned \$330 million through dividends and share repurchases last year – an increase of \$48 million from the prior year.

We also continued to advance our **Good Done Right** platform across our Food, Footprint and People priorities with a focus on responsible sourcing, community impact and more sustainable operations across our Company and franchise restaurants. These efforts reflect our commitment to long-term value creation while supporting responsible business growth.

ADVANCING OUR TURNAROUND THROUGH PROJECT FRESH

Project Fresh is our strategic action plan to turn around the U.S. business by driving profitable AUV growth, elevating the customer experience and improving franchisee economics. With Project Fresh as our north star, we are acting with urgency as *One Wendy's* to execute against our four strategic pillars – **brand revitalization, operational excellence, system optimization and capital allocation**.

Within brand revitalization, we are re-establishing Wendy's as the highest quality choice in QSR, which centers on engaging with consumers in more relevant and distinctive ways. We've established a disciplined marketing framework that keeps the brand top-of-mind with consumers and supports higher customer frequency while providing adequate training time for restaurant teams to enable them to execute with excellence. This approach also creates the space to drive greater food innovation with the goal of strengthening our craveable core, delivering relevant value and bringing impactful innovations to market more effectively. We are focused on elevating the effectiveness of our marketing and optimizing our mix by allocating more resources towards digital, social and streaming platforms, and increasing culturally relevant marketing across these channels.

Operational excellence continues to be a critical component of our strategy. In 2025, we introduced

enhanced training, rolled out a new learning management system and expanded our field operations teams to support more consistent execution across the U.S. business. These actions are driving improvement in our Company-operated restaurants, and we expect additional progress as adoption of these initiatives accelerates across the system.

We also took meaningful steps to optimize our U.S. restaurant footprint by focusing on restaurants with the greatest potential for profitable growth while closing a specific number of consistently underperforming restaurants. This initiative will extend into 2026 as we continue working closely with franchisees to enhance performance and improve franchisee profitability.

To support our U.S. turnaround efforts and sustain international expansion momentum, we continue to prioritize investments with the highest return. We are redeploying resources from U.S. development initiatives like the Build to Suit program, towards driving profitable AUV growth. This includes investments in additional field team resources to better support operational excellence in our restaurants, restaurant technology to improve workflow, and digital infrastructure investments to improve our data capabilities that support marketing effectiveness.

FORWARD FOCUS

As we look ahead, we recognize the opportunity in front of us and our priorities are clear: deliver consistent performance improvement across the U.S. business, build on the strength of our international business and deliver an exceptional experience for our customers.

Wendy's is an iconic global brand with significant white space for expansion. With Project Fresh underway to strengthen the franchise system and a clear focus on profitable AUV growth, we are building a more resilient and higher-performing Wendy's for the long term.

I'm excited about our plans for 2026, and I'm grateful to our employees, franchisees, suppliers and Board of Directors for their continued support and partnership.

Sincerely,



KEN COOK
INTERIM CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER
& CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER